

Philipp Hilbert. *Data platform product ownership.*

Positioning, Thirteen years owning product in regulated, data-heavy environments, turning business rules and messy source data into clean, trusted platform outputs.

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§ WHY MARGO

MARGO is building a data platform that has to serve both business stakeholders who care about client data and sales strategy, and engineering teams who build the pipes. That gap between business intent and technical execution is exactly where I have worked throughout my career, at the Federal Employment Agency's national labour-market analytics platform, at Rohde & Schwarz's FCAS AI and data platform, and at Bundesdruckerei's secure data platform for the Robert Koch Institute. The requirement to validate data quality and output consistency, coordinate from discovery through to stakeholder acceptance, and maintain documentation in Confluence maps directly to what I have been doing across those roles. *Those are the environments where this kind of work compounds.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo requirements and spec work
- **GitHub Copilot**, SQL and script assistance
- **Cursor**, exploratory data and code investigation
- **Jira**, backlog and story management
- **Confluence**, data and project documentation
- **Miro**, discovery workshops and process mapping
- **Lovable**, rapid prototype walkthroughs with stakeholders
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder communication and presentations

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL, ETL pipeline design, Jenkins CI/CD, Azure DevOps, Docker, Kubernetes, Python, REST APIs, Matomo, MicroStrategy, GitLab, ArgoCD, MongoDB, Kafka, used across live data platform deliveries at the Federal Employment Agency, Rohde & Schwarz, and Bundesdruckerei.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B staffing marketplace, built solo from zero to live.

- Handles anonymised matching between construction firms and workers, with identity revealed only after payment commitment.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface; LLM agents run the matching and qualification funnel so one person operates the day-to-day.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis written in SQL.
 - Demonstrates end-to-end data product thinking: from data model design through pipeline logic to business reporting, the same loop MARGO's Data Product Owner role owns.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT MARGO

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the existing Client Data and Sales Strategy Data workflows, read available data documentation in Confluence, and meet every Data Owner and Steward to map where the real source-of-truth debates sit.

WEEK 2

Validate and slice.

Take the backlog items already in Jira, validate the acceptance criteria against actual data structures in the platform, flag any criteria that cannot be tested, and rewrite the ones that can be sharpened.

WEEK 3 +

Ship and document.

Drive the first delivery through validation and stakeholder acceptance, close the loop with updated Confluence documentation, and build a repeatable handover template for the next domain.

I COVER LETTER

Dear MARGO team,

I am applying for the Data Product Owner role. My background is product ownership on data platforms in regulated industries, labour-market analytics for the Federal Employment Agency, AI and data infrastructure for the FCAS defence programme, and identity and health data platforms at Bundesdruckerei and CLINET.

The role description maps closely to work I have done in each of those engagements. At the Federal Employment Agency I owned a national analytics platform end to end: I gathered requirements from policy analysts and data owners, translated those into user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira, introduced Dagster and dbt to replace manual ETL steps, and cut the time per data update by roughly 75%. Validating data quality and output consistency was a weekly task, not a one-time activity, because the downstream consumers, policymakers and researchers, caught errors in production if we did not catch them first. At Rohde & Schwarz I coordinated a cross-functional team of 15 engineers and data scientists through Scrum, using Jira and Confluence to keep requirements, decisions, and handover documentation in one place.

On the technical side: I use SQL for data investigation regularly, I have shipped ETL pipelines with dbt and Dagster, and I am comfortable working in Azure DevOps environments. I do not have deep daily Databricks or Power BI experience, but I have worked alongside reporting and analytics teams in similar setups and know where the hand-off between data platform and reporting layer sits.

What I find interesting about this role specifically is the combination of Client Data and Sales Strategy Data as the business domains. Those two domains tend to have very different data owners with very different success criteria, and making them share a coherent platform requires the kind of careful requirements work and stakeholder coordination that I have been doing for the past several years.

I would be glad to walk through any of the platform work in more detail.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product Owner and Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership in regulated, data-heavy industries. I have owned data platform delivery end to end, requirements gathering, user story writing, ETL pipeline coordination, data quality validation, and stakeholder acceptance, across public-sector analytics, defence AI infrastructure, and healthcare data. I translate business needs into clear requirements for data and engineering teams, write user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira, and maintain documentation in Confluence.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Spearheaded development of the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.
- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG /
REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update; gathered requirements from data owners and policy analysts and maintained documentation in Confluence.
- Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline and freed several QA hours every week; migrated the platform fully into containers.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system (KIS) workflows: digital anamnesis time dropped from 30 minutes to 5.
- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose more than fivefold.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent.
- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition dropped from near-total exodus to a single departure.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL &
CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

- Retail and payments. Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 -
06/2021

- Government, secure data platform. Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

- Health insurance, B2B procurement webshop. Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019 - 12/2019

- Wind energy, full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017 - 06/2018

- Healthcare, clinical network. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.
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§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - 06/2026

- Construction staffing B2B marketplace. Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; LLM agents across the matching funnel.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption hardware and software. Owned backup, restore, and data-encryption product architecture; later Chair of the board.

CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO, SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES, BERLIN | 03/2018 - 08/2021

- Nanotechnology and agriculture. Financial planning and investor reporting from lab to investor rounds.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile P2P payments. Built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.
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§ SKILLS

Product Owner / Data Platform: user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, backlog refinement, sprint planning, data requirements documentation, data quality validation, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Analytics and Data: ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt (data build tool), SQL, PostgreSQL, MicroStrategy, Matomo, funnel and conversion analysis.

Technical Environments Owned: Azure DevOps, Docker, Kubernetes, Python, Jenkins, GitLab, ArgoCD, REST APIs, Kafka, MongoDB.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, user research, A/B testing, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

LinkedIn · GitHub · www.true-north.berlin · YouTube (EN sample)